

small groups. You can also search for a group based on relevant keywords, city and postal code.

GroupLoop.com provides a facility to create and manage groups with an ability to share files. The site also includes a messaging mechanism and calendar module with which you can organize groups effectively. The site will be useful for private clubs, companies and families.

Eventbrite.com enables you to invite your group for a meeting. For example, if you run a group for Java programmers, you can invite all members for a monthly meeting. The service is completely free as long as you are not charging users to attend an event. It is also compatible with mobile devices and hence you will be able to know about events on the go.

Invite your Group for an Event

SureToMeet.com enables you to create meeting registrations, email invites and organize events. The service is free for group meetings and events without credit card registration.

Hoop.la provides an ability to create groups and content with a wide range of types such as blogs, forums, surveys, chats, events, images, videos and private messages. You will be able to use your own themes and navigation menus. However, the service is expensive but you can subscribe to 30 day free trial.

Ning.com enables you to create groups and sub groups with forums, blogs, social media support. Moreover, the service is compatible with mobile devices and includes a drag and drop builder with privacy control and moderation support. The service is paid with 14 day free trial.

Forums provide real time interaction with people. You can now create a free web based forum for your community with Zetaboards.com. It includes customization features which enable you to change the look and feel of your forum. The company offers free support via tickets and also through a comprehensive documentation. The site also provides a forum directory where you can find other communities similar to your topic area.

Vanilla Forums offers both cloud hosted and self-hosted platforms, which is available free of cost. You need to download the source files and install it on a shared server by following their instructions. However, you have to pay a recurring amount in case if you opt for their cloud hosted platform after the expiry of 30 day free trial. It includes several premium features such as Q&A, mentions, notifications, avatars, private messaging in addition to migration services.